

This is one of the few SaaS opportunities in South Africa that checks several important boxes:

- Existing budget already exists.
- Existing pain already exists.
- No behavior change required.
- Regulatory complexity creates a moat.
- AI can reduce labor costs.
- Expansion path into payroll, tax, accounting, and compliance.

I would not call it a CRM.

I would position it as:

ComplianceOS

The Operating System for South African Compliance, Accounting & Advisory Firms

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Product Name

ComplianceOS

Alternative names:

- LedgerFlow
 - MandateOS
 - Praxis Compliance
 - FormFlow
 - RegistryOS
 - FilingHub
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Vision

Provide South African compliance, accounting, tax, and advisory firms with a single platform to manage clients, documents, workflows, compliance obligations, and communications.

The platform becomes the operational layer between:

- Clients
 - Consultants
 - SARS
 - CIPC
 - Department of Labour
 - BEE Agencies
 - Payroll Providers
-

Problem Statement

South African compliance firms currently operate using:

- WhatsApp
- Email
- Excel
- Shared Drives
- Sage
- Manual follow-ups

This results in:

- Lost documents
 - Missed deadlines
 - Compliance failures
 - Staff inefficiency
 - Poor client visibility
 - Revenue leakage
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Target Customers

Tier 1

Small compliance firms

Employees:

- 2–20

Services:

- Company registration
- Tax
- Bookkeeping
- BEE

Examples:

- Independent accountants
 - Tax practitioners
 - Business consultants
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Tier 2

Mid-sized accounting practices

Employees:

- 20–100

Services:

- Payroll
 - VAT
 - Annual financial statements
 - Tax compliance
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Tier 3

Enterprise

- Outsourced CFO firms
- Payroll providers
- Business service groups

Core Value Proposition

Before ComplianceOS:

WhatsApp
Email
Excel
Google Drive
Manual reminders

After ComplianceOS:

Single Client Record
Single Task Queue
Single Document Repository
Single Compliance Timeline

MVP Features

Module 1

Client Management

Store:

- Company Name
- Registration Number
- Tax Number
- Directors
- Contact Details
- Assigned Consultant

User Story

As a consultant

I want a complete client profile

So I can manage work from one place.

Module 2

Workflow Engine

Services become workflows.

Example:

Company Registration

Document Collection

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Name Reservation

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Mandate Signature

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Registration Filing

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Certificate Delivery

Example:

VAT Registration

Collect Documents

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Verify

↓

Submit

↓

Follow Up

↓

Completed

User Story

As an operations manager

I want standardized workflows

So all consultants follow the same process.

Module 3

Document Management

Store:

- IDs
- Tax Certificates
- Bank Statements
- COR Documents
- VAT Certificates

Features:

- Version control
 - OCR extraction
 - Search
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User Story

As a consultant

I want all client documents in one place

So I never request the same file twice.

Module 4

WhatsApp Client Inbox

Connect via:

- Twilio

- Meta Business API

Features:

- Incoming documents
 - Chat history
 - Workflow-linked conversations
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User Story

As a consultant

I want WhatsApp integrated

So I can work without switching platforms.

Module 5

Task Management

Statuses:

New

Waiting on Client

Processing

Submitted

Completed

Overdue

Features:

- SLA tracking
 - Due dates
 - Escalations
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Phase 2

AI Document Processing

Client sends:

Bank Statement.pdf

AI extracts:

```
{  
  "bank": "FNB",  
  "period": "May 2026"  
}
```

Classification:

ID Document
Tax Certificate
Bank Statement
COR14.3
VAT201

AI Compliance Assistant

Consultant asks:

How do I process a SARS objection?

Assistant returns:

Procedure
Required Documents
Expected Timeline

AI Workflow Suggestions

System identifies:

Missing Tax Clearance
Upcoming VAT Deadline
Expired BEE Certificate

Phase 3

Compliance Monitoring Engine

Track:

SARS

- VAT
- PAYE
- Income Tax

CIPC

- Annual Returns
- Beneficial Ownership

Labour

- UIF
- COIDA
- Employment Equity

BEE

- Certificate Expiry
 - Verification Schedule
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Dashboard Example

72 Clients Compliant

14 Clients Need Action

5 Critical Deadlines This Week

Phase 4

Billing & Revenue Management

Generate:

- Quotes
- Invoices
- Retainers

Track:

- Payments
 - Outstanding balances
 - Monthly recurring revenue
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Multi-Tenant Architecture

Every accounting firm becomes a tenant.

Tenant

- ├ Users
- ├ Clients
- ├ Tasks
- ├ Documents
- └ Workflows

Strict tenant isolation.

Roles

Consultant

- Manage clients
- Process tasks

Operations Manager

- Monitor workload
- Assign work

Administrator

- Manage users
- Configure workflows

Client

- Upload documents
 - View status
 - Sign mandates
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Success Metrics

Efficiency

- 50% reduction in admin time

Communication

- 70% reduction in document chase-ups

Revenue

- Increase consultant capacity by 2x

Compliance

- Reduce missed deadlines by 90%

Pricing Strategy

Starter

R999/month

- 3 users
- 100 clients

Growth

R2,999/month

- 10 users
- 1,000 clients

Professional

R7,999/month

- Unlimited users
- AI features

Enterprise

Custom pricing

Why This Could Become Large

The initial market looks like compliance firms.

But the long-term vision is broader:

ComplianceOS



AccountingOS



Business Services OS

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South African SME Operating Layer

The strongest wedge is not accounting software (Sage and Xero already dominate there). The wedge is **workflow orchestration around regulatory compliance**, where firms still rely heavily on WhatsApp, email, PDFs, and human follow-ups. That gap remains surprisingly underserved.